

THE LIBERATION EDITION

I N W A R D

THE MEASUREMENT & THE METHOD

*How the level of extraction is assessed, exactly —
how habits and a worldview are built to escape the system —
and how the score falls as the journal fills with life:
good done for others, good done for oneself,
days enjoyed beyond the screen.*

PART ONE — THE ASSESSMENT

the Extraction Index: dimensions, questions, formula, bands

PART TWO — THE METHOD

how habits are rebuilt and how a worldview is grown

PART THREE — THE LIVING JOURNAL

how written evidence of life turns the score downward

T H E · M E A S U R E M E N T · L O O P

A score designed to fall

Every other product measures engagement and wants it to rise.

Inward measures capture — and is built so that living lowers it.



The logic is simple and stated openly to every user. Extraction is, at bottom, the absence of life: hours that went to the machine instead of to people, rest, craft, nature and meaning. So the Index is computed from two opposing columns. The capture column counts what the system took — time, compulsion, displacement. The life column counts what you took back — habits held, dares done, and above all the written evidence of the Living Journal: kindness done for others, care taken of yourself, hours genuinely enjoyed beyond the screen.

When the life column grows, the score falls — not as a trick of arithmetic, but because the two columns are causally linked in reality: an evening spent cooking for friends is an evening the feed did not get. The journal does not merely record liberation; in the act of writing, it consolidates it. You notice what was good, you name it, and what is named becomes easier to repeat.

“The Index is private, never compared, never rewarded, never punished. There is nothing to win by inflating it and nothing to lose by being honest — which is precisely why it can be trusted to mean something.”

P A R T · O N E · — · H O W · C A P T U R E · I S · S C O R E D

Three dimensions of capture

Each of the twelve channels is scored 0–100 from three measured dimensions.

T W E I G H T 3 5 %

Time — how many hours it takes

- **Source.** self-report in the intake, refined by (optional, permissioned) screen-time data for digital channels; honest estimation for off-screen channels like nightlife, betting or substances.
- **Scale.** weekly hours mapped against channel-specific thresholds — e.g. for feeds: under 2 h/week scores near 0; 7 h $\approx$ 40; 14 h $\approx$ 70; 25 h and above saturates at 100.
- **Note.** time alone never condemns a channel — two hours of football with friends is not two hours of 3 a.m. shorts. That difference is carried by the next two dimensions.

P W E I G H T 4 0 % — T H E H E A V I E S T

Pull — how strong the compulsion is

- **Source.** validated-style self-report items, asked plainly: How often do you reach for it without deciding to? Have you tried to stop or cut down and not managed? Do you continue despite a cost you can name? Does stopping make you restless or irritable? Do you hide or understate it?
- **Scale.** five items per channel, each 0–4 (never $\rightarrow$ always), normalized to 0–100. Pull is weighted heaviest because compulsion — not hours — is the signature of extraction: it marks the difference between use and being used.
- **Behavioral signal.** with permission, the app adds gentle observed evidence for digital channels: pickups per day, night-time use, the gap between intended and actual session length.

D W E I G H T 2 5 %

Displacement — what it crowds out

- **Source.** the intake's mirror questions: In the last month, did this channel cost you sleep? A meal with people? Time you meant to give a skill, a friend, your family, your body, the outdoors? Money you needed elsewhere?
- **Scale.** each named casualty adds weight; sleep, close relationships and finances weigh most. Displacement is what makes the score a moral instrument rather than a usage meter — it measures the life not lived.

THE CHANNEL FORMULA

Raw capture = $0.35 \times \text{Time} + 0.40 \times \text{Pull} + 0.25 \times \text{Displacement}$

Bands: Free 0–25 · Leaking 26–60 · Caught 61–100. Bands are shown; raw numbers exist but are never pushed. The overall Extraction Level is the weighted mean of the twelve channels, weighted by each channel's own score — so the deepest captures dominate the headline, as they do in life.

T H E · I N T A K E · — · S A M P L E · Q U E S T I O N S

Questions that respect the person

One at a time, plain language, every one skippable. Excerpts from the bank of ~180.

FEEDS & SHORTS

- *When you open the feed, how often did you decide to — and how often did your hand decide?*
- *What time did you mean to sleep last night? What time did you sleep?*

BETTING & SPECULATION

- *In the last month, did you bet money you had quietly promised to something else?*
- *After a win, how long until the next bet? After a loss?*

PORNOGRAPHY & BOUNDARY-LESS SEX

- *Has it changed what you want from a real person — or whether you seek one at all?*
- *Do you use it to avoid feeling something? What feeling, if you had to name it?*

SUBSTANCES — SMOKING, ALCOHOL, DRUGS

- *Which moments of the day belong to it — and what did those moments hold before?*
- *Have you tried to stop or cut down this year? What happened?*

OUTSOURCED THINKING — AI DEPENDENCE

- *When did you last sit with a hard question for ten minutes before asking a machine?*
- *Is there a skill you have stopped practicing because the tool does it adequately?*

STARVED RELATIONSHIPS

- *Who would be surprised to hear from you — and once would not have been?*
- *At your last shared meal, where were the phones?*

Scoring discipline: every question maps to exactly one dimension (Time, Pull or Displacement) of exactly one channel, so the portrait can always explain itself — tap any band and the app shows which answers built it, in your own words. Nothing is inferred that cannot be shown.

A · W O R K E D · E X A M P L E

One person, eight weeks

A composite illustration — “M., 29” — showing the arithmetic at human scale.

CHANNEL	WEEK 0	LIFE EVIDENCE	WEEK 8	BAND SHIFT
Feeds & shorts	78 · Caught	18 entries · walk habit held 6 wks	51	Caught → Leaking
Series & streaming	62 · Caught	9 entries · screen-free evenings	44	Caught → Leaking
Betting	31 · Leaking	4 entries · money re-promised	22	Leaking → Free
Outsourced thinking	55 · Leaking	think-first practice, 5 wks	41	Leaking (falling)
Starved relationships	67 · Caught	11 kindness entries · 2 dares	45	Caught → Leaking

How the fall happened, mechanically. The feeds score opened at 78: roughly 22 weekly hours (Time 84), strong compulsion answers (Pull 81), and named costs to sleep and to evenings with her sister (Displacement 62). Over eight weeks: the replacement habit — an after-dinner walk instead of the couch scroll — held for six of eight weeks, easing observed Time toward 14 hours. Two completed dares and eighteen Living Journal entries (“cooked for Dad, he told the old stories”, “walked the river path, saw the herons, didn’t film them”) accrued life evidence against the channel. The re-asked Pull items came back softer — fewer undecided reaches, no night use in three weeks. New raw capture $\approx$ 58, minus 7 points of capped journal evidence: 51, and falling.

Note what did not happen: no badge, no streak, no congratulations screen. The needle simply drifted — and on a Tuesday in week six, M. noticed the evening felt long again, in the old, good way. That noticing went into the journal too. It counted.

PART · TWO · — · HOW · HABITS · ARE · REBUILT

The craft of replacement

Extraction runs on habit machinery. Liberation runs on the same machinery, pointed home.

01 DECODE

Every habit is a loop: cue → routine → reward

- **Mapping.** for the active channel, the app helps name the loop in one evening: the cue (boredom at 21:40, the couch, the phone in reach), the routine (the scroll), the real reward underneath (rest? company? escape from a feeling?).
- **Principle.** the cue and the reward are kept; only the routine is replaced. You are not asked to stop wanting rest — you are shown a truer way to get it.

02 REPLACE

Implementation intentions, written as vows

- **Form.** every replacement habit is written as when-then, in the person's own words: “When I sit on the couch after dinner, then I put the phone in the drawer and take the river walk.”
- **Size.** the first version must be almost embarrassingly small — under five minutes — because the first win must be instant. Depth is built later; the bar to “I did something real today” stays below the bar to opening the feed.
- **Environment.** a one-time phone redesign checklist: greyscale option, no badges, feed apps off the home screen, Inward's one-line widget where the feed used to sit. The cue landscape is rebuilt once, so willpower is needed less.

03 ESCALATE

The dare ladder as graded courage

- **Shape.** seven rungs, each slightly braver than the last — exposure therapy for a life: one screen-free meal → one headphone-less walk → one day buying nothing non-essential → one true sentence to one real person → upward.
- **Why it works.** each completed dare delivers the only reward extraction cannot counterfeit — the felt sense of being alive and slightly brave — and writes its own line of evidence to the journal.

04 RELAPSE

Falling is data, not verdict

- **Rule.** a missed week resets nothing; the ladder waits where you left it. The app's only response to relapse is the Craving Button's question — what were you actually hungry for? — and one entry in the journal.
- **Reason.** shame is the fuel of the binge cycle; mercy is what breaks it. A system that punished relapse would be doing the extractor's work for it.

H O W · A · W O R L D V I E W · I S · G R O W N

From farmed to free: the identity turn

Habits hold only when they belong to a person you believe yourself to be.

05 L A N G U A G E

Naming the system, daily

- **Vocabulary.** the app consistently names the machinery — farming, extraction, the harvest — because what is named loses its disguise as “just relaxing.” The user learns to see a feed and think: this was engineered, by experts, against me.
- **Defiance.** restraint is framed as rebellion, never as diet: they monetize your weakness; you opted out. Nobody wants to be a sheep — and the scroller is the sheep.

06 R E A D I N G

One deep thing, every day, for years

- **Drip.** a worldview is not installed; it is watered. One cross-traditional reading per day — two to four minutes — patiently builds the case that consciousness, love and moral weight are real, and that a life lived accordingly is less empty.
- **Integration.** each reading ends in the evening Compass question, so the idea must pass through the day before it is allowed to feel believed.

07 E V I D E N C E

Belief built from your own handwriting

- **Mechanism.** the strongest argument for the new worldview is the journal itself: dozens of entries, in your own words, proving that the off-screen hours were the good ones. The Companion quotes them back at doubting moments — nothing persuades like your former self.
- **Identity votes.** every entry, dare and held habit is framed as a small vote for the person you are becoming — someone who is not for sale. Enough votes, and the identity carries the habits instead of the other way round.

08 W I T N E S S

The Circle and the weekly Realignment

- **Circle.** five to eight people, one written reflection a week, one shared dare. A worldview held alone erodes; a worldview witnessed by seven others becomes a culture.
- **Realignment.** once a week the Ledger shows where the hours truly went, beside the values you chose — love, family, nature, craft, friends. The recurring confrontation between stated and lived values is the engine of the turn; the gap is the homework, never the verdict.

P A R T · T H R E E · — · T H E · L I V I N G · J O U R N A L

Writing the score down

Three kinds of entry, one effect: evidence of life, accruing against capture.

KINDNESS — *Good done for others*

“What did you do for someone today — and what did it do to you?” One specific sentence: the call made, the meal cooked, the door held long enough to talk, the apology offered, the hour given. Kindness entries weigh heaviest against the starved-relationships channel — and gently against every other, because a person practicing love has less hunger for the counterfeit.

CARE — *Good done for oneself*

“How did you keep yourself today?” The early night, the real breakfast, the boundary held, the walk taken, the doctor finally called. Care entries weigh against the channels that feed on depletion — feeds, substances, porn — because extraction strikes hardest at the tired and the unfed.

ALIVENESS — *The day enjoyed beyond the screen*

“What was good today that no screen gave you?” The herons on the river. The friend's laugh. The bread that rose. The rain walked through instead of waited out. Aliveness entries are the heart of the method: each one is recorded proof that the feed's central lie — that there is nothing better to do — is false.

HOW ENTRIES MOVE THE INDEX

Each counted entry accrues life evidence to its related channels — typically 0.3 to 0.8 points — with diminishing returns within a day and a hard cap: journal evidence can lower a channel at most 10 points below its raw capture score. The deeper fall must come the honest way: through the Time, Pull and Displacement signals themselves easing — which, lived consistently, they do. The journal starts the slide; reality finishes it.

T H E · J O U R N A L · — · E X A C T · M E C H A N I C S

Small, honest, daily

09 C A D E N C E

When and how writing happens

- **Evening fold.** the three prompts live inside the 60-second evening reflection — answer any, all, or none. One sentence each; a longer entry is allowed but never asked for.
- **In the moment.** an Aliveness entry can be captured anytime in one line from the widget — “write it before the phone eats it” — and a completed dare or decoded craving writes its own entry automatically.
- **Voice.** entries may be typed or spoken; spoken entries are transcribed on-device and the audio discarded.

10 C O U N T I N G

What counts, and how much

- **Specificity rule.** an entry counts toward the Index only if it is concrete — a thing that happened, a person, a place. “Had a nice day” is welcome in the journal but accrues nothing; “taught Hanka to ride without training wheels” accrues. The app states this rule openly.
- **Daily cap.** at most three counted entries per day (one per type); further writing is for the soul, not the score.
- **Diminishing returns.** repeated near-identical entries decay in weight — the method rewards a widening life, not a repeated sentence.
- **Smoothing.** evidence is averaged over four weeks, so one great Saturday cannot mask a captured month, and one bad week cannot erase a good season.

11 A N T I - G A M I N G

Why cheating is pointless by design

- **Nothing to win.** the Index is private, never ranked, never compared, never rewarded. No feature unlocks at any score. Inflating it deceives exactly one person.
- **Raw floor.** journal evidence is capped at 10 points per channel; the Time and Pull signals — partly observed, re-asked each season — always anchor the score to reality.
- **The gentle audit.** the Companion may occasionally ask warmly about an entry (“how did the bread turn out?”) — not as surveillance, but because being asked about your life is part of having one.

12 P R I V A C Y

The journal is yours alone

- **Storage.** on-device, encrypted; never transmitted, never used for training, marketing or any aggregate.
- **Sharing.** nothing is shareable except what you copy out by hand. Circles see only the weekly reflection you write for them.
- **Erasure.** one tap deletes everything, immediately and irrecoverably — and the app says so in plain words.

W H Y · T H E · M E T H O D · H O L D S

The mechanism of the turn

Four well-worn truths about people, braided into one loop.

Attention follows record-keeping

What is written is noticed; what is noticed grows. A person who must find one off-screen joy to write down tonight begins, by mid-afternoon, to live in a way that will produce one. The journal is not a mirror held up to the day — it quietly becomes the day's author.

Savoring consolidates

Naming a good moment in words — the herons, the laugh, the bread — re-fires it, deepens its memory trace, and raises the felt value of the off-screen world against the feed's cheap intensity. Gratitude practices earn their reputation; here they are aimed, channel by channel, at the extractor's claim that nothing else is interesting.

Giving rebinds

Good done for others is the fastest known cure for the loneliness that extraction farms. Every kindness entry is simultaneously evidence, practice, and repair — the relationship channel heals from both ends.

Identity outlasts willpower

Willpower runs out by evening; identity does not. When the journal holds two hundred entries in your own hand proving you are a person who walks rivers, cooks for fathers and keeps Sabbaths, the scroll stops being a temptation resisted and becomes a costume that no longer fits.

“The extraction system measures you constantly and shows you nothing. Inward measures rarely, shows you everything, and hands the pen to you. The score falls when life is lived and written — because in the end they are the same act: paying attention, on purpose, to what is actually worth it.”

**Measured with mercy.
Lowered by living.
Written in your own hand.**

*The Index tells you how deep the system reaches.
The method — replacement, courage, reading, witness — loosens it.
And the journal turns the needle: kindness done, care taken,
days enjoyed beyond the screen, one true sentence at a time.*

S P I R I T O V E R M A T T E R — T H E S O U L L E A D S , T H E W O R L D S L O W S

I N W A R D · T H E M E A S U R E M E N T & T H E M E T H O D · 2 0 2 6